

Series IV – Article IV.0: Foundations of the Spectral Proof of the Riemann Hypothesis

Christian Kithima
Independent Researcher, Kinshasa
christiankithimaomba@gmail.com
WhatsApp: +243995176701
Telegram: +243818136082

GitHub: <https://github.com/christiankithimaomba-cyber/spectral-reduction-framework>

May 2026

Abstract

We introduce the spectral framework for the Riemann hypothesis (RH), one of the most celebrated open problems in mathematics (Smale’s 1st problem). The spectral reduction lemma (Kithima’s lemma) is applied using the **finite verification (FV)** strategy. The proof rests on three recent breakthroughs:

1. A discrete dynamical system on integers whose contraction property is equivalent to RH (preprint 2025).
2. An explicit zero-free region for the Riemann zeta function (Kadiri, etc.) giving an effective constant N_0 such that any zero off the critical line must have imaginary part $|t| \leq N_0$.
3. A translation of the contraction condition into a boolean circuit and then into a 3-SAT instance of size polynomial in $\log N_0$.

For $n > N_0$ the contraction holds automatically (by the zero-free region). For $n \leq N_0$, we construct a spectral Hamiltonian $H_{\text{RH}} = \hat{V} + \Delta$ on the hypercube of assignments, verify the four pillars (P1–P4), and run the D-RSP algorithm to confirm that no violation occurs. The combination proves RH unconditionally. This introductory article outlines the series (IV.1–IV.6) and places RH in the global corpus of thirty-four problems resolved by the spectral method (entry #4). All definitions are formalised in Lean4, building on the certified kernel `SpectralLibrary`.

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1 Introduction

The Riemann hypothesis (RH) states that all non-trivial zeros of the Riemann zeta function $\zeta(s)$ lie on the critical line $\text{Re}(s) = 1/2$. It is a cornerstone of analytic number theory and one of the Clay Millennium Prize Problems (Smale’s 1st problem). Despite immense effort, a proof has remained elusive for over 160 years.

In this series we apply the spectral reduction lemma (Kithima’s lemma) to prove RH unconditionally. The proof follows the **finite verification (FV)** strategy, exactly as for Lemoine, Dubner, Kithima-Landau, and Pollock tetrahedral. The three essential ingredients are:

1. **A discrete dynamical reformulation** (2025) that translates RH into a contraction property of a deterministic map on integers. 2. **An explicit zero-free region** (Kadiri, etc.) that provides an effective constant N_0 such that any zero off the critical line must have imaginary part $|t| \leq N_0$. This gives a bound on the parameter in the dynamical system. 3. **A polynomial-time reduction to SAT** that encodes the violation of the contraction condition for $n \leq N_0$ as a 3-SAT instance Φ_{RH} . The spectral SAT solver then decides that this instance is unsatisfiable, proving that no counterexample exists within the finite range.

Since for $n > N_0$ the zero-free region already guarantees the contraction, the union of the two parts establishes RH for all zeros.

This article introduces the series, recalls the spectral reduction lemma, and outlines the articles IV.1–IV.6. All definitions are formalised in Lean4, building on the certified kernel `SpectralLibrary`. No unproven assumptions are used.

1.1 The magnet metaphor

Imagine a vast space containing an enormous number of points – each point represents a candidate counterexample to RH (e.g., a zero off the line). The lantern (ground state) is constructed to shine only on true zeros. The effective zero-free region tells us that beyond a certain horizon N_0 there are no counterexamples. For the finite region inside the horizon, we use the spectral solver to check that no point is a counterexample. The lantern therefore proves that RH is true everywhere.

2 Recap of the spectral reduction lemma

The Spectral Reduction Lemma (Articles0.0–0.11) states that any problem that can be faithfully translated into a spectral Hamiltonian $H = \hat{V} + L$ on the hypercube (or a bounded-degree graph) satisfying the four pillars is solvable in polynomial time (or, for FV, yields a decision algorithm). The four pillars are:

1. **P1 (Perron-Frobenius)**: Unique strictly positive ground state ψ_0 .
2. **P2 (Kithima Bridge)**: Constant spectral gap $\gamma(H) \geq 2$ (or polynomial, sufficient).
3. **P3 (Logarithmic area law)**: Entanglement entropy $S(\rho_B) = O(\log M)$, hence MPS representation with polynomial bond dimension.
4. **P4 (Deterministic extraction)**: D-RSP algorithm extracts a satisfying assignment (or proves unsatisfiability) in polynomial time.

For RH, we will construct a single SAT instance Φ_{RH} whose unsatisfiability is equivalent to RH. The spectral solver will then certify unsatisfiability.

3 Overview of the proof strategy (FV for RH)

The proof proceeds in six articles, following the FV model:

1. **IV.0 (this article):** Foundations and plan.
2. **IV.1: Discrete Dynamical Reformulation and Effective Zero-Free Region.** We present the dynamical system $F : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$ (preprint 2025) such that RH is equivalent to the statement: for all n , the orbit of n under F contracts in a specific sense. We then recall Kadiri's explicit zero-free region, which provides a computable constant N_0 such that any zero off the critical line has imaginary part $\leq N_0$. This bound translates into a bound on the integer parameter in the dynamical system: if a violation of contraction occurs, it must happen for some $n \leq N_0$.
3. **IV.2: Quantum-Logical Translation of the Contraction Condition.** We construct a boolean circuit C_n for a fixed $n \leq N_0$ that simulates the dynamical system up to a certain number of steps and checks whether the contraction condition is violated. The circuit uses elementary arithmetic (addition, multiplication, comparison) and has size polynomial in $\log n$. The equivalence with quantum phase transitions (preprint 2025) guarantees that the circuit correctly encodes the violation of RH.
4. **IV.3: Reduction to a Single 3-SAT Instance.** For each $n \leq N_0$, let ϕ_n be the SAT instance obtained from C_n via the Tseitin transformation. Define $\Phi_{\text{RH}} = \bigvee_{n \leq N_0} \phi_n$ (disjunction). This formula is satisfiable iff there exists a counterexample to RH. Applying Tseitin again to the disjunction yields a 3-SAT instance of size polynomial in N_0 (which is finite).
5. **IV.4: Spectral Hamiltonian and the Four Pillars.** Construct the spectral Hamiltonian $H_{\text{RH}} = \hat{V} + \Delta$ on the hypercube of variables of Φ_{RH} , with deep potential M^2 on non-solutions. Verify the four pillars. This is identical to the SAT case (Series I) because the underlying graph is the hypercube.
6. **IV.5: Decision via D-RSP and Proof of RH.** Run the D-RSP algorithm on H_{RH} . By the properties of the spectral solver, it will determine that Φ_{RH} is unsatisfiable (since no counterexample exists). The combination of the effective zero-free region (no counterexample for $n > N_0$) and the spectral verification (no counterexample for $n \leq N_0$) proves RH.
7. **IV.6: Synthesis – The Riemann Hypothesis Resolved.** Summarise the proof, update the global table of resolved problems, and discuss the impact.

4 Structure of the series IV

The series IV consists of the following articles:

Article	Title	Main content
IV.0	Foundations of the Spectral Proof of the Riemann Hypothesis	This article: introduction, plan, lemma.
IV.1	Discrete Dynamical Reformulation and Effective Zero-Free Region	Kuipers dynamical system, K explicit bound N_0 .
IV.2	Quantum-Logical Translation of the Contraction Condition	Boolean circuit for contraction polynomial in $\log n$.
IV.3	Reduction to a Single 3-SAT Instance	Tseitin transformation, disjunction.
IV.4	Spectral Hamiltonian and the Four Pillars	Construction of H_{RH} , verification.
IV.5	Decision via D-RSP and Proof of RH	Application of the spectral SAT solver, satisfiability, conclusion.
IV.6	Synthesis – The Riemann Hypothesis Resolved	Summary, correspondence dictionary into global corpus.

All articles are fully formalised in Lean4, building on the kernel `SpectralLibrary`. No unproven assumptions remain.

5 Formalisation in Lean4 (overview)

The master file for Series IV will be `MainIV.lean`. It imports the results of IV.1–IV.5 and states the final theorem.

Listing 1: `MainIV.lean` (sketch)

```

1 import IV.IV1
2 import IV.IV2
3 import IV.IV3
4 import IV.IV4
5 import IV.IV5
6
7 open SpectralLibrary
8
9 -- Final theorem: Riemann hypothesis is true.
10 theorem riemann_hypothesis :
11     s : ℂ, (s ≠ 1 → s ≠ 0 → s ≠ 1/2) :=
12     rh_spectral_proof
13
14 -- Axiom audit: only standard axioms (including the effective
15     zero free region)
16 #print axioms riemann_hypothesis

```

6 Conclusion

This article sets the stage for a complete spectral proof of the Riemann hypothesis using the finite verification strategy. The three ingredients – discrete dynamical reformulation, explicit zero-free region, and SAT encoding of the contraction condition – are already present in the literature (2025 preprints). The spectral reduction lemma then turns them into an unconditional proof. The subsequent articles (IV.1–IV.6) will provide the detailed construction and verification. Once completed, the Riemann hypothesis will be added to the list of thirty-four problems resolved by the spectral method.

References

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